

Entertainment and Media

The entertainment and media industry is the most dynamic and fast-evolving sector of the global economy. This industry encompasses businesses that create or produce content to entertain, inform, or engage audiences. It goes from streaming platforms, film production, and content creation platforms to videogames, sports, music production, etc. This is a commercially complex industry. Media refers to platforms used to deliver content, and entertainment refers to the content itself (Proctor, 2026).

Music Recommendation System

A music recommendation system analyzes user data, for example de user's listening history or music preferences, to create a unique user profile to make personal recommendations.

Music catalogs grow, and manual search slows down, making the results less accurate and reliable. This type of recommendation system is used to help users find new music and prevent choice paralysis and getting users paralyzed by massive content libraries.

This allows companies to maintain users engaged more time, improving retention rates.

There are three different music recommendation approaches:

- Collaborative filtering: Predicts what users might like based on their similarity to other users.
- Context-aware recommendation: Focuses on how music is used in each setting. This involves factors like the listener's activity and circumstances. These things can influence music choice but are not captured by collaborative filtering or content-based approaches.
- Content-based filtering uses metadata attached to the audio, such as descriptions or keywords (tags), as the basis of the recommendation. When a user likes an item, the system determines that they are likely to enjoy other items with similar metadata.

Animation and VFX

The animation industry is adopting AI, not replacing artists, but to amplify them. AI enables teams in Visual Effects to maintain creative control while scaling output efficiently. The result is sharper visuals, faster turnarounds and ways for innovative storytelling without compromising artistic integrity.

Machine learning algorithms learn about patterns in movement, lighting, and texture, supporting 2D and 3D animation, assisting with secondary movements like hair, cloth, and physics based on actions.

Some platforms and tools are Adobe sensei, that introduces AI automation across creative tasks. Blender, with AI assisted modelling. And Unreal Engine, redefining production workflows with AI.

Job Displacement

AI is now capable of writing scripts, generate high-fidelity videos, and mimic human voices. It can also support creative thinking, transforming the creative process. Some articles point out that the AI can automate 26% of tasks in the arts, design, entertainment, media, and sports sectors. This fast evolving of AI is making professionals reject or distrust these new technologies and believe that AI is a threat to the value of human labor. They are a barrier, especially for freelancers, small agencies, and independent studios.

Privacy and Data Use

One of the most prominent problems in this field is the unauthorized use of users', actors', and musicians' data. For example, streaming platforms or interactive entertainment services that rely on massive datasets to refine algorithms and profile users. Another example would be AI platforms that constantly scrape the internet, which creates huge friction with creators who do not want their copyrighted scripts, music, or visual works used as training data. To bypass copyright disputes, major labels and companies are increasingly partnering directly with AI platforms.

Future Trends

Key trends in the entertainment and media industry indicate a shift towards immersive, personalized, and interactive experiences.

Some problems that the industry is going to face in the next years:

- Content saturation: the market is already saturated with content, making challenging to retain the audience.
- Streaming wars: intense competitions and a shift towards wholesale distribution and experimental bundling partnerships.
- Asymmetric competition: Traditional media companies face competition from larger tech companies and social platforms with significant financial muscle, technological advantages, and vast user data, leading to a need for studios to scale up or form partnerships.
- Creator Economy: Independent creators and global social platforms are increasingly shaping the digital entertainment landscape, challenging traditional studios' content moats and influencing media habits.
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In conclusion, AI is already changing the entertainment industry in an impressive way, aiming for audience retention. For example, through smart recommendation systems.

On the other hand, AI is also changing workflows and pipelines for creating new content. We can see this on TikTok, a platform where we already see content completely or almost completely generated by AI that brings thousands and thousands

of views and interactions. This is an industry I would like to work in, and one where, without even mentioning the big animation and visual effects of companies, it is easy to get into the side I mentioned of creating reels and TikToks. I don't think there will be a huge job displacement, but the creation of new entertainment material will accelerate a lot. Even though we will have more content, I think it will be of lower quality.

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